

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 4 3

♥ Q

♦ A 6 4 2

♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ J 10 6

♥ 9

♦ 8 5 3

♣ K Q J 9 5 2



♠ Q 8 5

♥ J 10 6 5 3 2

♦ Q J 9

♣ A

♠ K 9 2

♥ A K 8 7 4

♦ K 10 7

♣ 10 8

South opens 1♥ and West Doubles.

After the intervening Takeout Double **2/1 is OFF**. If you had 10 or more points you would Redouble. So even with only 9 points you can bid 2♣ without fear that South will think you have a strong hand. South also knows everything mentioned above so he passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Dbl

2♣<sup>1</sup>

All Pass

1. 6+ ♣s, fewer than 10 points

**Board 3**

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5  
 ♥ A 10 6 5 3  
 ♦ 10 5 4  
 ♣ 10 9 5 4

♠ A K 9 8 7 6 4

♥ K Q 7

♦ K 7 3

♣ -



♠ 10 3  
 ♥ 9 8 4  
 ♦ A 9  
 ♣ Q 8 7 6 3 2

♠ Q J 2

♥ J 2

♦ Q J 8 6 2

♣ A K J

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
|      | 1 ♠   | Pass | 2 ♦   |
| Pass | 2 ♠   | Pass | 3 ♠   |
| Pass | 4 ♣   | Pass | 4 ♠   |

All Pass

South would have shown one Ace and North wouldn't know what to do next. She might have figured the odds favored that one Ace being a red one and tried the slam. Moral: Don't use Blackwood when you have a void.

You have a great hand - how will you start the bidding? You open 1 ♠. South responds 2 ♦, a 2/1 force to game. You have a big hand, perhaps in the slam range, but first priority is to set a trump suit. So you contend yourself with a rebid of 2 ♠. South agrees on trumps by bidding 3 ♠ (not Fast Arrival). What do you do now? Now you make your slam try by using a Control-showing cue-bid. She bids 4 ♣, showing first or second round control of the suit (Ace or king, or singleton or void). South bids 4 ♠. What do you do now?

South's next bid would be a control-showing bid of her own - IF SHE HAD ONE. Since she cannot win the first or second round of either red suit she just returns to 4 ♠. North realizes that they are off two red Aces and passes. Notice that North did not fall into the Blackwood trap. If you HAD asked for Aces,

**Board 5**

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 6  
♥ J 9 6 4  
♦ 10 9  
♣ 8 6 4 2

♠ 7 4

♥ Q 7 3

♦ A K J 7 3

♣ K J 9



♠ K 5 3

♥ 10 5

♦ 8 6 5 4

♣ A Q 7 3

♠ A J 10 8 2

♥ A K 8 2

♦ Q 2

♣ 10 5

South opens 1♠. You respond 2♦, a 2/1 force to game. Partner rebids 2♥, showing a 4-card side suit.

You don't have 4♥s, nor do you have have 3♠s. You do, however, have stoppers in ♣s so you bid 2NT. South happily says 3NT.

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1♠    |
| Pass     | 2♦    | Pass | 2♥    |
| Pass     | 2NT   | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass |       |      |       |